



Cybersecurity Career Roadmap

Choose your path. Build the right skills. Get career-ready.

SOC & Security Operations	GRC & Risk
Cloud Security	Application Security

Your structured path to cybersecurity career readiness — **TeamUp Consultants**

Start Here

Cybersecurity offers diverse career paths for individuals from various backgrounds. Whether you're starting fresh, transitioning from IT, or looking to advance your security career, this roadmap helps you identify a direction, build relevant skills, create practical evidence, and prepare for your next opportunity.



New to Cybersecurity

Begin building foundational cybersecurity knowledge and explore roles that match your interests and strengths.



IT Professional

Transfer your existing IT, networking, systems, cloud or development experience into a cybersecurity career path.



Student or Recent Graduate

Use your academic foundation to build practical cybersecurity skills, projects and evidence.



Existing Security Professional

Strengthen your current capabilities, identify your next target role and build evidence for career progression.

My Target Role

Target cybersecurity role:
Why this role interests me:
My current experience:
My biggest skill gap:

Choose Your Cybersecurity Path

Cybersecurity is not one career. Explore the path that best matches your interests, existing strengths and long-term goals.



Security Operations / SOC

Work on: Incident response, security monitoring, alert investigation and threat detection.

Core skills: Network security, log analysis, threat analysis, incident response.

Tools: SIEM platforms, log management, security monitoring tools.

Roles: SOC Analyst, Security Analyst, Incident Responder.

Best for: People who enjoy investigation, analysis and solving security problems.



GRC & Risk / Compliance

Work on: Risk assessments, compliance activities, security controls, audits and governance.

Core skills: Risk management, governance, regulatory knowledge, documentation.

Tools: GRC platforms, audit tools, risk registers and compliance frameworks.

Roles: GRC Analyst, Risk Analyst, Compliance Analyst.

Best for: People who enjoy structure, documentation and business-focused security.



Cloud Security

Work on: Cloud infrastructure security, identity and access management, security configuration.

Core skills: Cloud platforms, IAM, security architecture, networking.

Tools: AWS security services, Microsoft Azure security tools, cloud monitoring platforms.

Roles: Cloud Security Engineer, Cloud Security Analyst.

Best for: People interested in cloud infrastructure and securing modern environments.



Application Security

Work on: Secure software development, vulnerability assessment, application security testing, API security.

Core skills: Software development, web application security, vulnerability assessment.

Tools: OWASP resources, static analysis tools, application security testing tools.

Roles: Application Security Engineer, Security Engineer.

Best for: People with programming interests who want to apply security to applications.

Find Your Route Into Cybersecurity

Your previous experience can become an advantage when you choose a cybersecurity path that builds on what you already know.

Your Background → Your Path

IT Support	→ SOC Analyst
Network Administration	→ Network Security
System Administration	→ Security Engineering
Cloud / DevOps	→ Cloud Security
Software Development	→ Application Security

My Transition Plan

Current role/background:
Target cybersecurity role:
Skills I already have:
Skills I need to build:
Experience I can transfer:
First practical project:

Build the Right Cybersecurity Skills

Use this checklist to assess your current capabilities and identify the skills you need to strengthen for your target role.

Security Foundations

- ☐ Networking & TCP/IP
- ☐ DNS
- ☐ Authentication & Access control
- ☐ Vulnerabilities & Threats
- ☐ Incident response

Technical Security Skills

- ☐ SIEM / Log analysis
- ☐ Intrusion detection
- ☐ Vulnerability assessment
- ☐ Firewalls & Encryption
- ☐ Cloud security
- ☐ Application security

Professional Skills

- ☐ Communication & Teamwork
- ☐ Problem-solving
- ☐ Analytical thinking
- ☐ Documentation & Attention to detail

Skill Gap Assessment

Skill	Current Level	Gap?	Action
	Beginner Mid Adv	Yes No	
	Beginner Mid Adv	Yes No	
	Beginner Mid Adv	Yes No	
	Beginner Mid Adv	Yes No	
	Beginner Mid Adv	Yes No	

 Prioritize the top 3 skill gaps that appear most frequently in job descriptions for your target role.



Build Proof of Your Cybersecurity Skills

Knowing a security concept is useful. Showing how you apply it is stronger evidence when preparing for cybersecurity roles.

SOC / Security Operations

- SIEM investigation
- Log analysis
- alert triage
- Incident-response exercise

GRC / Risk

- Risk assessment
- Risk register
- Control mapping
- Security policy

Cloud Security

- IAM security project
- Cloud configuration assessment
- Logging and monitoring

Application Security

- OWASP assessment
- API security testing
- Secure coding project

Project Evidence Checklist

- ☐ Project objective defined
- ☐ Tools/technologies documented
- ☐ Problem or security scenario explained
- ☐ Investigation or implementation documented
- ☐ Findings recorded
- ☐ Recommendations documented
- ☐ Results explained
- ☐ Project added to portfolio

What Employers Look For

Hiring teams evaluate more than technical knowledge. Strong candidates can demonstrate how they apply their skills, communicate decisions and approach security problems.



Technical Capability

Understanding of the technologies, concepts and security practices relevant to the role.



Practical Application

Evidence that you can apply security knowledge to realistic problems and scenarios.



Problem Solving

Ability to investigate issues, identify risks and develop appropriate solutions.



Communication

Ability to explain technical findings and security decisions clearly.



Security Judgment

Ability to evaluate risk, prioritize issues and make thoughtful security decisions.



Evidence

Projects, labs, work experience, certifications and other evidence that demonstrate your capabilities.

My Strongest Evidence

My strongest technical skill:
A project that demonstrates it:
A problem I solved:
What I learned:
How I would explain this in an interview:



Your First 30 Days — Build Your Foundation

Create a focused foundation for your cybersecurity career transition.

Week 1 — Choose Your Direction

-  Choose one target cybersecurity role
-  Review 10 relevant job descriptions
-  Identify recurring skills and technologies
-  List your existing strengths
-  Identify your top 3 skill gaps

Week 2 — Strengthen Fundamentals

-  Review networking fundamentals
-  Strengthen security fundamentals
-  Review operating systems relevant to your path
-  Learn core concepts related to your target role

Week 3 — Start Hands-On Practice

-  Choose one practical project
-  Set up a lab or practice environment
-  Practice relevant security tools
-  Document what you learn

Week 4 — Review

-  Complete your first project milestone
-  Review your skill gaps
-  Update your learning priorities
-  Begin organizing your portfolio

30-Day Checkpoint	 Target role selected	 Skills prioritized
 First project started	 Practical experience underway	

Days 31–60 — Build Practical Evidence

Develop role-specific skills and prepare your professional profile.

Build Role-Specific Capability

-  Complete a practical cybersecurity project
-  Practice technical scenarios
-  Work with relevant security tools
-  Document your findings
-  Build a second project or lab

Build Your Professional Profile

-  Update your cybersecurity resume
-  Improve your LinkedIn profile
-  Add relevant cybersecurity keywords
-  Add practical projects
-  Prepare your career-transition story

Prepare for Interviews

-  Practice technical questions
-  Practice scenario-based questions
-  Prepare STAR examples
-  Practice explaining your projects
-  Prepare questions for employers

60-Day Checkpoint

-  Practical evidence created
-  Resume updated
-  LinkedIn updated
-  Projects documented
-  Interview preparation started



Days 61–90 — Become Career-Ready

Execute your job search and build professional momentum.

1

Finalise

Resume, LinkedIn, projects and portfolio ready for applications.

2

Apply

Target aligned roles, tailor your resume, track applications and follow up.

3

Network

Connect with professionals, follow security teams and engage communities.

4

Improve

Record interview questions, identify gaps, and refine your preparation continuously.

Prepare for the Job Search

-  Finalize your cybersecurity resume
-  Finalize your LinkedIn profile
-  Complete your strongest projects
-  Organize your portfolio
-  Identify target companies and roles

Start Targeted Applications

-  Apply to roles aligned with your skills
-  Tailor your resume where appropriate
-  Track applications and interview stages
-  Follow up on applications

Build Your Professional Network

-  Connect with cybersecurity professionals
-  Follow relevant security teams
-  Engage with relevant communities
-  Connect with appropriate recruiters
-  Track conversations and follow-ups

90-Day Checkpoint

-  Career direction defined
-  Practical evidence ready
-  Resume and LinkedIn ready
-  Interview preparation completed
-  Targeted job search underway

My Cybersecurity Career Plan

Document your personal roadmap to cybersecurity career readiness.

Target cybersecurity role:	
Target career path:	
Current background:	
Strongest skills:	
Biggest skill gaps:	
Practical evidence:	
Development plan:	
My 30-day goal:	
My 60-day goal:	
My 90-day goal:	

☐ Ready to take the next step? TeamUp Consultants supports job seekers across all cybersecurity career paths. Reach out to learn how we can support your journey.

